Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Friday, 16 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Rain	Rain	Heavy drizzle	Light drizzle
17° 10°	13° 8°	13° 8°	12° 8°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The former leader of Northern Ireland's DUP, Jeffrey Donaldson, has been sentenced to 15 years in prison for child sex abuse.**

Mr Donaldson was convicted of 18 counts, including rape, against two women when they were children. This brings a shocking end to a prominent political career.

CRIME · UK

2 **New NHS England guidance says trans patients should use hospital spaces according to their biological sex.**

The guidance states that trans patients should be cared for on single-sex wards or bays that align with their biological sex. This is a significant update for patient care.

HEALTH · UK

3 **An inquest has heard that a man killed by a tiger at Yorkshire Wildlife Park died from 'multiple injuries'.**

William Chapman climbed two fences to enter the tiger's pen, the inquest was told. It's a tragic story from the popular park.

INCIDENT · UK

4 **An accuser of Russell Brand has described him turning 'monster-like' before an alleged rape.**

The 51-year-old comedian and actor faces three counts of rape, three charges of sexual assault, and one of indecent assault. The case continues to be a major talking point.

CRIME · UK

5 **Severe drought has now been declared in parts of southern England after a hot summer and less rain than usual.**

Reservoir levels continue to drop, impacting water supplies in various regions. It's a stark reminder of our changing climate.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Lena Dunham's hit series 'Girls' is set to return for a limited HBO run, ten years after its finale.**

The show will explore the characters reaching the 'milestone of turning forty'. Fans will be thrilled to catch up with Hannah, Marnie, Jessa, and Shoshanna.

ON AIR — Are you excited for the return of 'Girls'? What do you think the characters will be like at forty?

TV · COMING UP

2 **Ray Winstone has been charming locals in a Welsh market town while filming his new action comedy, 'Danger Money'.**

Winstone plays Alan 'Razor' Sharp, an ex-SAS operative, in the new flick. It sounds like he's making quite an impression!

ON AIR — Ray Winstone is a British acting legend! What's your favourite film or TV show he's been in?

FILM · COMING UP

3 **Robert Pattinson stars in the new film 'Primetime', portraying the real-life host of 'To Catch a Predator'.**

The movie delves into how hunting predators became hit TV. It sounds like a gripping and intense role for Pattinson.

ON AIR — Robert Pattinson is taking on a serious role. What kind of films do you prefer to see him in?

FILM · COMING UP

4 **Jorja Smith has expressed her gratitude after winning a prestigious independent music prize.**

The singer reflected on her 'crazy' journey as she collected the award for best independent track. It's a fantastic achievement for the talented artist.

ON AIR — Jorja Smith is a brilliant British artist. What's your favourite track by her?

MUSIC · TODAY

5 **Davina McCall has revealed her memory loss after brain surgery was like having 'advanced Alzheimer's'.**

The TV presenter suffered memory loss following an operation to remove a benign tumour. She's been incredibly open about her health journey.

ON AIR — Davina McCall is so brave for sharing her story. What an inspiring woman!

TV · TODAY

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Australia clinched a thrilling Rugby League World Cup opener against New Zealand, winning 24-22.**
Debutante Jack Bostock scored a hat-trick to help the hosts snatch victory late on in Sydney. What a way to start the tournament!
ON AIR — What a dramatic start to the Rugby League World Cup! Did you manage to catch the game?
RUGBY LEAGUE · INTERNATIONAL

2 **Great Britain has claimed two gold medals at the Track World Championships.**
They won in the women's team pursuit and the men's scratch race. A fantastic performance on the world stage!
ON AIR — Two golds for Team GB! Are you a fan of track cycling, or do you prefer road racing?
CYCLING · INTERNATIONAL

3 **Britain's Sonay Kartal continues her impressive comeback, reaching the Wuhan Open quarter-finals.**
Kartal beat former Wimbledon finalist Jasmine Paolini in straight sets. She's definitely one to watch!
ON AIR — Sonay Kartal is making waves in tennis! Who are your favourite British tennis players?
TENNIS · INTERNATIONAL

4 **Defending champions Paris Saint-Germain made it two wins from two in the Champions League, beating Manchester City 4-2.**
It was a slick performance from PSG at the Etihad Stadium. City will be disappointed with that result.
ON AIR — Manchester City fell short against PSG. Do you think they'll still go far in the Champions League?
FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Bradley Barcola scored a hat-trick as Liverpool beat LASK 6-3 in Austria, making it two wins from two in the Champions League.**
It was a goal-fest for Liverpool, securing another strong result in the group stage. What a night for Barcola!
ON AIR — Liverpool are off to a flying start in the Champions League! How far do you think they can go this season?
FOOTBALL · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **The simple act of 'doodling on a steamy mirror' is becoming a small, mindful moment of creativity for many.**
As the bathroom steams up, people are finding a moment of calm, turning condensation into a fleeting canvas for playful drawings or uplifting messages before it all disappears.

2 **More of us are finding a quiet satisfaction in the 'gentle thrum of a washing machine' on its spin cycle.**
It's a surprisingly soothing background noise, offering a steady rhythm to quiet contemplation or the perfect soundtrack to a good book.

3 **The delightful discovery of 'a perfectly ripe avocado' is being celebrated as a small daily triumph.**
That moment when you cut into one and it's just right – not too hard, not too mushy – is bringing a surprising amount of joy to breakfast tables across the nation.

4 **A new trend sees people embracing the 'art of making a perfectly neat bed' each morning.**
It's a small act that sets a positive tone for the day, creating a sense of order and calm that many find surprisingly impactful.

5 **The unexpected pleasure of 'finding a coin down the back of the sofa' is still a little thrill for many.**
Whether it's a 20p piece or a shiny pound coin, that unexpected discovery feels like a tiny bonus from the universe, often leading to a nostalgic trip down memory lane.

6 **Many are rediscovering the charm of 'sending a postcard' from their local area, even if they're not on holiday.**
It's a lovely way to connect with friends and family, sharing a little piece of home with a handwritten message that feels much more personal than a text.

7 **The 'satisfying click of a perfectly shut biscuit tin' is bringing a small moment of order to many kitchens.**
There's something wonderfully reassuring about knowing your favourite treats are safely sealed away, keeping them fresh for that next cuppa.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?**

ANSWER: GIVING THE BAG A QUICK SHAKE TO GAUGE THE 'CRISP RUSTLE' FACTOR!

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of chocolate, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: SNIFFING IT REALLY DEEPLY TO APPRECIATE THE AROMA BEFORE BREAKING OFF A SINGLE PIECE.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday smell' just instantly transports you back to a specific memory or place, even if it's something as simple as freshly cut grass or baking bread?**
  What everyday smell instantly takes you on a trip down memory lane, and what's the memory attached to it?

- **There's something wonderfully satisfying about 'getting to the bottom of a jar' or bottle, isn't there? That moment when you've used every last bit of something you love.**
  What's that one product – whether it's jam, a fancy condiment, or a lovely hand cream – that you find truly satisfying to finish right down to the very last scrape?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Penguins have a special gland that allows them to drink seawater and filter out the salt, expelling it through their beaks.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.4 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.4 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The 'royal wave' made by members of the British Royal Family is a specific, gentle sideways turn of the hand from the wrist, not a full arm wave.
- A bolt of lightning is six times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- The only letter in the alphabet not appearing in the name of any US state is the letter 'Q'.
- Bubble wrap was originally intended to be used as three-dimensional wallpaper.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to find host plants and nectar.
- The classic children's toy, the Slinky, was invented by accident in 1943 when a naval engineer dropped a spring.
- The world's quietest room is located at Microsoft's headquarters in Washington state, where background noise is -20.35 dBA.
- Cows don't have upper front teeth; instead, they have a tough dental pad.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES FRI 16 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 289 of the year, 76 days left in 2026. Today Air Force Day (Bulgaria); Boss's Day (United States); Christian feast day: Balderic (Baudry) of Monfaucon; Christian feast day: Bertrand of Comminges. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1928 — Ann Morgan Guilbert, American actress (died 2016)
- 1958 — Tim Robbins, American actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1960 — Bob Mould, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1947 — Bob Weir, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2026)
- 1959 — Gary Kemp, English singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actor
- 1973 — David Unsworth, English footballer and manager
- 1962 — Flea, Australian-American bass player, songwriter, and actor
- 1969 — Wendy Wilson, American singer-songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1970 — Canadian Prime Minister Pierre Trudeau invokes the War Measures Act during the October Crisis.
- 1995 — The Million Man March takes place in Washington, D.C. About 837,000 attend.
- 1998 — Former Chilean dictator Augusto Pinochet is arrested in London on a murder extradition warrant.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1962 — Cuban Missile Crisis begins: U.S. President John F. Kennedy is informed of photos taken on October 14 by a U-2 showing nuclear missiles (the crisis will last for 13 days starting from this point).
- 1949 — The Greek Communist Party announces a "temporary cease-fire", thus ending the Greek Civil War.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1975 — The Australian Coalition sparks a constitutional crisis when they vote to defer funding for the government's annual budget.
- 1978 — Cardinal Karol Wojtyła is elected to the papacy as Pope John Paul II, he becomes the first non-Italian pontiff since 1523.
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1946 — Nuremberg trials: Ten defendants found guilty by the International Military Tribunal are executed by hanging.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES SAT 17 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 290 of the year, 75 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anstrudis; Christian feast day: Catervus; Christian feast day: Ethelred and Ethelberht; Christian feast day: Florentius of Orange. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1948 — Margot Kidder, Canadian-American actress (died 2018)
- 1946 — Michael Hossack, American drummer (died 2012)
- 1977 — Alimi Ballard, American actor and producer
- 1992 — Jacob Artist, American actor, singer, and dancer
- 1960 — Bernie Nolan, Irish singer (died 2013)
- 1937 — Paxton Whitehead, English actor (died 2023)
- 1940 — Jim Smith, English footballer and manager (died 2019)
- 1977 — Bryan Bertino, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1966 — The 23rd Street Fire in New York City kills 12 firefighters.
- 1977 — The hijacked Lufthansa Flight 181 lands in Mogadishu. The remaining hostages are later rescued.
- 2017 — Syrian civil war: The Syrian Democratic Forces (SDF) capture the last foothold of the Islamic State of Iraq and the Levant (ISIL) in Raqqa, marking the end of the Battle of Raqqa.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2004 — A fire that lasted over 15 hours destroyed almost one third of the East Tower of the Parque Central Urban Complex in Caracas, Venezuela.
- 1965 — The 1964–65 New York World's Fair closes after two years and more than 51 million attendees.

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10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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